My Spelling Words: /ou/ & /ô/

Name: _____ Date: _____

/ou/ like cloud & cow: spelled ou (proud) or ow (tower).
/ô/ like saw & ball: spelled aw (claw), au (pause), or a before l (bald).
Rule-breaker: couple has ou, but it says short u (like cup)!

/ou/ — like cloud & cow

ou aloud south proud amount cloudier ounce★

ow tower howl allow drown coward★

/ô/ — like saw & ball

aw hawk claw dawn sprawl★

au faucet pause fault cause author★

a+l bald stalk false

Tricky words: look closely!

couple (ou says short u, like cup)
cloudier (cloudy + ier: change y to i)
ounce (ends with ce that says /s/)
stalk (silent l: you don't hear it)
faucet (au, then c says /s/)
author (au, then th)

Helpful hints (most of the time):

- ou is usually in the middle: proud, south, amount
- ow is usually at the end or before n, l, er: allow, drown, howl, tower
- aw is usually at the end or before k, l, n: claw, hawk, dawn
- au is usually in the middle: pause, fault, faucet

★ = challenge word (optional, for extra practice).

Word Sort: Which Sound?

Name: _____ Date: _____

Say each word. Which vowel sound do you hear? Write it in that box.
Then circle the letters that spell the sound (ou, ow, aw, au, or a before l).

Word Bank

hawk	aloud	pause	tower	bald	couple
south	claw	fault	drown	stalk	proud
dawn	howl	false	amount	faucet	allow
cause	cloudier	author	sprawl	ounce	coward

/ou/ like cloud & cow

_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____

/ô/ like saw & ball

_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____
_____	_____

Odd one out! has ou, but no /ou/ sound

_____

Hint: not every line gets a word. Challenge words (author, sprawl, ounce, coward) are optional.

ou or ow? aw or au?

Name: _____ Date: _____

Say the word. Write the missing letters. Then write the whole word.

ou or ow? ou in the middle (proud). ow at the end or before n, l, er (allow, drown).
aw or au? aw at the end or before k, l, n (claw, hawk). au in the middle (pause, fault).

1. h____k (aw / au) _____
2. al____d (ou / ow) _____
3. p____se (aw / au) _____
4. t____er (ou / ow) _____
5. s____th (ou / ow) _____
6. cl____ (aw / au) _____
7. f____lt (aw / au) _____
8. dr____n (ou / ow) _____
9. pr____d (ou / ow) _____
10. d____n (aw / au) _____
11. h____l (ou / ow) _____
12. am____nt (ou / ow) _____
13. f____cet (aw / au) _____
14. all____ (ou / ow) _____
15. c____se (aw / au) _____
16. cl____dier (ou / ow) _____
17. ____thor (aw / au) _____
18. spr____l (aw / au) _____
19. ____nce (ou / ow) _____
20. c____ard (ou / ow) _____

Fill in the Blank (1 of 2)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Pick a word from the word bank. Write it on the line. Each word is used once.

Word Bank (all 24 words)

stalk	coward	claw	howl	proud	author
dawn	south	pause	ounce	tower	fault
aloud	couple	drown	bald	sprawl	cause
hawk	amount	false	allow	faucet	cloudier

1. The _____ dove down to catch a mouse.
2. Mia was _____ of the robot she built.
3. Let's _____ the game and eat lunch.
4. We built a _____ of blocks as tall as the table.
5. The kitten caught its _____ on the blanket.
6. Florida is _____ of Georgia.
7. Grandpa has a shiny _____ spot on his head.
8. I need a _____ of sharp pencils for the test.
9. The farmer gets up at _____ to feed the cows.
10. Will your mom _____ you to sleep over?
11. It is nobody's _____ that it rained.
12. Measure the right _____ of flour for the cake.

Fill in the Blank (2 of 2)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Pick a word from the word bank. Write it on the line. Each word is used once.

Word Bank (all 24 words)

stalk	coward	claw	howl	proud	author
dawn	south	pause	ounce	tower	fault
aloud	couple	drown	bald	sprawl	cause
hawk	amount	false	allow	faucet	cloudier

13. Dad laughed _____ at the funny movie.

14. The dogs _____ when a fire truck goes by.

15. The kitchen _____ dripped all night long.

16. Plants can _____ if they get too much water.

17. A _____ of celery stuck out of the bag.

18. "Fish can fly" is a _____ statement.

19. A loose wire was the _____ of the problem.

20. Today is _____ than yesterday was.

21. The _____ of this book drew the pictures.

22. After the hike, we like to _____ out.

23. There is not one _____ of juice left.

24. The brave knight was no _____.

Spelling Detective

Name: _____ Date: _____

Each sentence has ONE misspelled word. Circle it. Write it the right way.
Then write the letter of the clue that explains the mistake.

Clues

A. /ou/ in the middle of a word (before d, th, nt) is usually spelled ou.
B. /ou/ at the end of a word or before n, l, or er is usually spelled ow.
C. /ô/ at the end of a word or before k, l, or n is usually spelled aw.
D. /ô/ in the middle of a word (before s, c, lt, th) is usually spelled au.
E. In some words, /ô/ is spelled a before l, like ball.
F. This word has a silent l. Write it even though you can't hear it.
G. cloudy + ier: change the y to i, then add ier.
H. This word is a rule-breaker: ou says short u, like in cup.

1. A hauk landed on the fence post.

Right spelling: _____ Clue: _____

2. We climbed the steps of the old touer.

Right spelling: _____ Clue: _____

3. Mom was prowd of my science project.

Right spelling: _____ Clue: _____

4. The singer took a pawse to drink some water.

Right spelling: _____ Clue: _____

5. The rabbit nibbled a stak of celery.

Right spelling: _____ Clue: _____

6. It got cloudyer as the storm came closer.

Right spelling: _____ Clue: _____

7. I have a cupple of questions for the coach.

Right spelling: _____ Clue: _____

8. My uncle shaved his head, so now he is bawld.

Right spelling: _____ Clue: _____

Look, Say, Cover, Write, Check (1 of 2)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Look at the word and say it. Cover it and write it. Uncover it and check. ✓ = right!

Look & Say	Write & Check	Write & Check	Write & Check
aloud	☐	☐	☐
bald	☐	☐	☐
hawk	☐	☐	☐
south	☐	☐	☐
faucet	☐	☐	☐
proud	☐	☐	☐
claw	☐	☐	☐
tower	☐	☐	☐
stalk	☐	☐	☐
couple	☐	☐	☐
howl	☐	☐	☐
false	☐	☐	☐

Look, Say, Cover, Write, Check (2 of 2)

Name: _____ Date: _____

Look at the word and say it. Cover it and write it. Uncover it and check. ✓ = right!

Look & Say	Write & Check	Write & Check	Write & Check
dawn	☐	☐	☐
allow	☐	☐	☐
drown	☐	☐	☐
pause	☐	☐	☐
fault	☐	☐	☐
cause	☐	☐	☐
amount	☐	☐	☐
cloudier	☐	☐	☐
author ★	☐	☐	☐
sprawl ★	☐	☐	☐
ounce ★	☐	☐	☐
coward ★	☐	☐	☐

ABC Order

Name: _____ Date: _____

Put each group in ABC order. Same first letter? Look at the next letter!

Group 1

Look at the 2nd letter!

aloud allow amount
author couple coward

1. _____ 4. _____
2. _____ 5. _____
3. _____ 6. _____

Group 2

Watch the 2nd and 3rd letters.

cause claw cloudier
dawn drown hawk

1. _____ 4. _____
2. _____ 5. _____
3. _____ 6. _____

Group 3

fau... fal... look closely!

faucet false fault
bald howl ounce

1. _____ 4. _____
2. _____ 5. _____
3. _____ 6. _____

Group 4

s and p words

south sprawl stalk
pause proud tower

1. _____ 4. _____
2. _____ 5. _____
3. _____ 6. _____

Practice Spelling Test

Name: _____ Date: _____

Listen to the word and the sentence. Write the word on the line.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____
6. _____
7. _____
8. _____
9. _____
10. _____
11. _____
12. _____
13. _____
14. _____
15. _____
16. _____
17. _____
18. _____
19. _____
20. _____
21. _____
22. _____
23. _____
24. _____

For Grown-Ups: Answer Key & Read-Aloud List

Word Sort (by sound)

/ou/ (like cloud & cow): aloud (ou), south (ou), proud (ou), amount (ou), cloudier (ou), ounce (ou), tower (ow), howl (ow), allow (ow), drown (ow), coward (ow)

/ô/ (like saw & ball): hawk (aw), claw (aw), dawn (aw), sprawl (aw), faucet (au), pause (au), fault (au), cause (au), author (au), bald (a+l), stalk (a+l), false (a+l)

odd one out (ou says short u): couple (ou)

ou or ow? aw or au?

1. aw (hawk)	5. ou (south)	9. ou (proud)	13. au (faucet)	17. au (author)
2. ou (aloud)	6. aw (claw)	10. aw (dawn)	14. ow (allow)	18. aw (sprawl)
3. au (pause)	7. au (fault)	11. ow (howl)	15. au (cause)	19. ou (ounce)
4. ow (tower)	8. ow (drown)	12. ou (amount)	16. ou (cloudier)	20. ow (coward)

Fill in the Blank

1. hawk	5. claw	9. dawn	13. aloud	17. stalk	21. author
2. proud	6. south	10. allow	14. howl	18. false	22. sprawl
3. pause	7. bald	11. fault	15. faucet	19. cause	23. ounce
4. tower	8. couple	12. amount	16. drown	20. cloudier	24. coward

Spelling Detective

1. hauk → hawk (clue C)
2. touer → tower (clue B)
3. prowd → proud (clue A)
4. pawse → pause (clue D)
5. stak → stalk (clue F)
6. cloudyer → cloudier (clue G)
7. cupple → couple (clue H)
8. bawld → bald (clue E)

ABC Order

Group 1: allow, aloud, amount, author, couple, coward
Group 2: cause, claw, cloudier, dawn, drown, hawk
Group 3: bald, false, faucet, fault, howl, ounce
Group 4: pause, proud, south, sprawl, stalk, tower

Practice Test: say the word, read the sentence, then say the word again.

1. hawk	A hawk circled high above the field.	**13. dawn**	The rooster crows at dawn.
2. aloud	Please read the poem aloud to the class.	**14. howl**	We heard a wolf howl at the moon.
3. pause	Press pause so we can get a snack.	**15. false**	Is that sentence true or false?
4. tower	The castle tower had a tiny window at the to...	**16. amount**	Add a small amount of salt to the soup.
5. bald	The bald eagle has white feathers on its hea...	**17. faucet**	Turn off the faucet while you brush your teet...
6. couple	We waited a couple of minutes for the bus.	**18. allow**	Our teacher does not allow phones in class.
7. south	Many birds fly south for the winter.	**19. cause**	Heavy rain can cause a flood.
8. claw	The crab pinched my finger with its claw.	**20. cloudier**	The sky looks cloudier than it did this mornin...
9. fault	It was not my fault that the vase broke.	**21. author**	The author signed my copy of her book.
10. drown	The loud music will drown out our voices.	**22. sprawl**	Our dog likes to sprawl on the warm rug.
11. stalk	The corn stalk was taller than my dad.	**23. ounce**	A slice of bread weighs about one ounce.
12. proud	I felt proud when I finished the puzzle.	**24. coward**	The lion was not a coward after all.